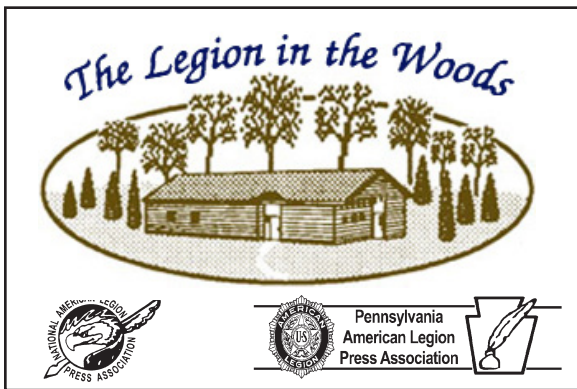




POST 245 NEWSLETTER

1950 PINE HALL RD., STATE COLLEGE, PA 16801

814-237-6880 EMAIL: INFO@NITTANYPOST245.ORG

WEBSITE: WWW.NITTANYPOST245.ORG

JULY 2026 - OCTOBER 2026

A Message from the Commander

It has been an honor and a pleasure to serve as your commander this past year. Thank you for entrusting me with this role again.

Over the past year, leadership has focused on strengthening the Post from within and getting our house in order. As promised, it has been a year of change. Along with visible improvements to the Post and property—including redecorating the game room, clearing the firebreak, planting grass, and updating the landscaping—we have made important structural changes to Post governance. The separation of the Post and the Social Club, also known as the Home Association, has been clearly established and documented. All committees now fall under the Post, with defined mandates and member-approved budgets that provide full transparency. At this time last year, we were in serious financial trouble. I am pleased to say that we have reversed that trend, reducing our debt from more than \$120,000 to less than \$40,000, and we are projected to be debt-free next spring. We also recently partnered with the Pennsylvania Lottery and are now an official lottery retailer, bringing horse racing, Keno, scratch-off tickets, and draw games to the Post. The Pennsylvania Supreme Court recently ruled that skill games are not legal, and we are waiting to see how that decision will affect our operations. Meaningful change takes time, and Post improvements will continue to be an ongoing process. We will keep building on this progress in the coming year, and I welcome your ideas for further improvement.

In the coming year, leadership will focus on looking up and out as we re-engage with the community. In partnership with our public nonprofit partner, Freedom Rising USA, we will host numerous events that celebrate our American heritage and support veterans. These include the Central Pennsylvania 250th Independence Day Parade in downtown State College; enhanced Memorial Day, Flag Day, and Veterans Day recognition ceremonies; brunches honoring veterans of the Korean and Vietnam conflicts and Purple Heart recipients; and brunches honoring Gold Star Families. On the entertainment side, the Post will host an Oktoberfest fundraiser on October 23rd and 24th, continue our dinner club events, and hold the annual picnic on August 8th. None of this can happen without volunteers, so please get involved. It is our Post—let's make it a great one!

For God and Country,
DJ Watkins
Commander, Nittany Post 245



Club Hours:

Mon-Sat: 11am-11pm

Sun: 1pm-10pm

Kitchen Hours:

Mon-Sat: Grill 11am-8pm

Mon-Sat: Fryers 11am-9pm

Sun: Fryers 1pm-7pm

Happy Hour:

Monday 7-9pm

Evening Specials Nightly!

Fridays

Wing Night 5-9pm

Membership - Nittany American Legion Post 245, Inc.

If you do not know already, I am stepping down as Adjutant for Nittany American Legion Post 245, Inc. The Post held the elections on June 18, 2026 and Mitch DeLong was elected as Adjutant. Mitch brings to our Post his experience as Adjutant from another Post. I have full faith that he will do an outstanding job.

Our final number for Post 245 membership is 659. We missed the 100% goal by 20. No feather in the cap this year. I want to thank each and every member who stayed loyal to Post 245 and hope that our younger and newer members will step up and fill some of the positions on the Post in the future years. We always need volunteers to serve and to do different projects around the Post. It is your Post, please take good care of it.

Last, it has been a pleasure serving you as your Adjutant. I learned a lot and met and made new friends during my tenure. I wish all of you great success in further ventures for the Post.

Larry Hess
Nittany American Legion Post 245, Inc.
Past Adjutant

NEWS FROM THE LADIES AUXILIARY

Hello from the Ladies Auxiliary!! We hope you are doing well and enjoying this beautiful summer weather.

The Ladies Auxiliary membership continues to grow. We are happy to announce our newest members: Jennifer Brauser, Nancy Butler, Dina Terrizzi, Sarah Watkins, Jenie Ellenberger, Joyce Igoe, Beth Bishop, Penny Condo, Joan Brower, Susan Yearick, Abby Walters, Kelly Felix, Norah Felix, Maya Felix, Karen Doyon, Hilary Henderson, Laurene Keck, Patty Rees, Lisa Wetzel, Debra Campbell, Stephanie Dry, and Christine Hale.

The Ladies Auxiliary meetings are held the fourth Tuesday of the month at 7 p.m. We would love to see some new faces at our meetings. Please note that there WILL NOT be a meeting in July. Our meetings are fun and informative and a great way to meet new people. Come to a meeting to learn what we do to support our veterans, our youth, and our community.

The Auxiliary held our first annual Sip and Gab on April 18th. All members received an invite in the mail. A good time was had by all that attended. The complimentary food was very good, and the free drinks were even better!!!! We hope to see you at the next one.
Looking forward to seeing you at the club!!

Donita Gibboney, Second Vice-President

~ In Memoriam ~

John Coughlin ~ Donald Bachman ~ Richard P Wolf
Daniel Holter ~ Robert C Keller ~ Edward R Tressler
Bradley A Fisher ~ John Brickell

BSA Troop 245 Corner

The American Legion BSA Troop 245 is growing! We welcomed nine new Scouts this spring and now have a total of 42 Scouts in our troop.

Throughout the year, our Scouts have completed numerous service projects, many of which have benefited The American Legion. The troop has assisted with Legion clean-up days, flag replacement at the cemetery, and raising and lowering flags for holidays such as Memorial Day and Flag Day. One of the highlights of the year is attending the Veterans Dinner. Our Scouts enjoy serving and talking with local veterans, and we are grateful for all they have done to protect our freedom. We could not be more proud of our Eagle Scouts. In May, we held a ceremony recognizing the achievements of three Scouts: Gus Clement, John Razzano, and Zach Spicer.

We are also proud of our 2026 graduates and Eagle Scouts, John Razzano and AJ Spak, who have turned 18 and aged out of the troop. We thank them for their years of service and leadership and wish them continued success in all their future endeavors.

We have a busy summer ahead! In June, a group of 10 Scouts traveled to the Summit Bechtel Reserve for a High Adventure experience. The troop is excited to participate in the Fourth of July Parade once again this year. Our Scouts enjoy marching proudly alongside our charter organization and honoring the veterans who have served our country.

Later in July, 22 Scouts will attend summer camp at Seven Mountains Scout Camp. We are also planning a trip to Gettysburg in August and look forward to another memorable summer of adventure, service, and fellowship.



Pine Hall Cemetery



Our New Eagle Scouts

NEWS FROM THE SAL

Hope you are all having a good summer so far!

Thanks for all the support on the SAL monthly gun raffles and for all the Legion members that bought or sold tickets. The SAL gun raffles have been a huge success and great fundraiser. Over the last year that has allowed us to donate funds to several charities and organizations.

The SAL will be co-supporting with the Auxiliary for the Healing Waters Day. Many Veterans will be going fishing for the day, then they will be arriving back to the Legion for a good hot meal. The SAL's and Auxiliary will be serving the meal. Help will be needed on July 11th from 4pm-8pm to help cook and serve the meal.

SAL has also been fortunate to accumulate many new members this year again. Welcome to all 40 new SAL members in 2026!

Reminder there is no SAL meeting in July so we will see you at the next meeting on August 20th.

Thanks,
Randy Weaver, SAL Commander



D. J. Watkins, Post 245 Commander, presented the ROTC awards for Penn State on Tuesday, April 14, 2026

Attention Legionnaires and Legion Family: Stay informed!
Email info@nittanypost245.org to get added to our mailing list if you're not receiving updates. Thank you!

2026 Post 245 Program Committee Activities and Organization Meetings:

7/1	6pm-10pm		Pool Room Pool League
7/2	10am-5pm		Red Cross Blood Drive ' T Shirt Give A Way '
7/2	6pm		Thursday Night Cornhole
7/4			July 4th / Club Closed
7/8	6pm-10pm		Pool Room Pool League
7/12			LEGION CLOSED
7/13			LEGION CLOSED
7/14	6pm		DATE CHANGED Special Events Meeting
7/15	6pm-10pm		Pool Room Pool League
7/15	6pm		Trivia Wednesday
7/18	730pm-1030pm	..	Line Dancing by Lion Country
7/22	6pm-10pm		Pool Room Pool League
7/26	11am-2pm		Korean War Veteran's Brunch
7/29	6pm-10pm		Pool Room Pool League
8/5	6pm-10pm		Pool Room Pool League
8/6	7pm		ALR Meeting
8/6	6pm		Thursday Night Cornhole
8/8			Post 245 Summer Picnic
8/10	6pm		Special Events Meeting
8/12	6pm-10pm		Pool Room Pool League
8/13	6pm		DINNER CLUB / Mexican Fiesta / with Comedy
8/19	6pm		Trivia Wednesday
8/20	6pm		SAL Monthly Meeting
8/20	7pm		Post Meeting / Dining Room
8/22	730pm-1030pm	..	Line Dancing by Lion Country
8/23	11am-2pm		Purple Heart Recognition Sunday Brunch
8/25	10am-5pm		Red Cross Blood Drive
8/25	7pm		Ladies Auxiliary Meeting
9/3	7pm		ALR Meeting
9/3	6pm		Thursday Night Cornhole
9/5	330pm		Penn State Football / Marshall
9/10			"DINNER CLUB / Chicken Parm, Salad, Bow Tie Pasta, Broc and Dessert"
9/11			Patriot's Day
9/12	12pm		Penn State Football / Temple
9/14	6pm		Special Events Meeting
9/16	6pm		Trivia Wednesday
9/17	6pm		SAL Monthly Meeting
9/17	7pm		Post Meeting / Dining Room
9/19	12pm		Penn State Football / Buffalo
9/19	730pm-1030pm	..	Line Dancing by Lion Country
9/22	7pm		Ladies Auxiliary Meeting
9/26			Penn State Football / Wisconsin
9/27	11am-2pm		Gold Star Mothers and Families Sunday Brunch

10/1	7pm	ALR Meeting
10/1	6pm	Thursday Night Cornhole
10/2	8pm	Penn State Football / Northwestern @ NIGHT
10/8		"DINNER CLUB / Schnitzel, Red Cabbage, Spaetzie, Tomato Salad and Dessert"
10/10		Penn State Football / USC
10/12	6pm	Special Events Meeting
10/15	6pm	SAL Monthly Meeting
10/15	7pm	Post Meeting / Dining Room
10/17		Penn State Football / Michigan
10/17	730pm-1030pm	Line Dancing by Lion Country
10/20	10am-5pm	Red Cross Blood Drive
10/21	6pm	Trivia Wednesday
10/23		Oktober Fest Kickoff
10/24		OKTOBER FEST Celebration
10/27	7pm	Ladies Auxiliary Meeting

Boy Scouts Meet Mondays at 7pm



Are YOU interested in volunteering?

Please do the following:

1. Go to <https://nittanypost245.org>
2. Click on the Volunteer Form link
3. Print it out and fill it in and drop off completed form at club

POST OFFICERS

Meets 3rd Thursday, 7 p.m.
Commander - D. J. Watkins
1st Vice - Dennis Clark
2nd Vice - Richard Jackson
Adjutant - Mitchell DeLong
Finance Officer - Chris Solo
Sgt. at Arms - Adam Krebs
Chaplain - David McElwee
Service Officer - Vacant
Judge Advocate - Philip Mowry
Historian/Public Affairs - Vacant
The at large members are:
Elected 2024-2026 Don Hartzell and Tom Hammond
Elected 2025-2027 Phillip Mowry and Micheal Miltenberger

AUXILIARY OFFICERS

Meets 4th Tuesday, 7 p.m.
President - Rhonda Spear
1st Vice - Penny Dry
2nd Vice - Donita Gibboney
Secretary - Kathy Croyle
Treasurer - Tina Johns
Sgt.-At-Arms - Karen Jackson
Chaplain - Jean Folk
Historian - Jessica Champain
Sp. Events Coord. - Brandi Hartman

SAL OFFICERS

Meets 3rd Thursday, 6 p.m.
Commander - Randy Weaver
1st Vice - Steve Selfe
2nd Vice - Casey Inhoof
Adj. / Treas. - Bob McCool
Sgt. at Arms - Rick Richards
Chaplain - Mike Boonie
Historian - Vacant

Legion In The Woods - Social Club - Meets 2nd Wednesday @ 6pm

Mitch DeLong - President, Dennis Clark - 1st Vice President, Rich Jackson - 2nd Vice President
Tom Hoy - Treasurer, Vacant - Secretary,
At Large Board Members: Chris Solo, Robert Beadle, Tom Hammond - One Vacancy

AMERICAN LEGION RIDERS 245 – Meets 1st Thursday @ 7pm

Director: Scott Spear	Vice-Director: Randy Weaver	Secretary: Rhonda Spear
Treasurer: Jeff Gonet	Chaplain: Brian McMahon	Road Captain: Samantha Hartman
Randy Weaver		

Below are the list of Post committees and their functions.

Please consider volunteering for any that interest you by contacting the chairman.

a. Post Constitution, Bylaws and House Committee.

Ensures the Post Constitution, Bylaws, rules and regulations conform to Department and National Requirements and recommends changes. Meets as required.

Chairman (Post JA):	Phil Mowry
Vice Chair (Post Adjutant):	Mitch DeLong

b. Membership Committee.

Oversees all aspects of membership including welcoming new members, buddy checks, public affairs and social media, and recruiting. The committee is chaired by the First Vice commander and meets as required.

Chairman (First Vice Commander):	Dennis Clark
Vice Chairman (Post Adjutant):	Mitch DeLong
Member (Sargeant at arms):	Adam Krebs
Member (Social Media):	Open

continued on next page

c. Community Service Committee.

Oversees public and community service programs including programs intended to provide support and assistance to families of members on active duty with the Armed Forces of the United States, veterans and members of the Post, Post Americanism activities and youth activities such as Boys State, Boy Scouts, Oratorical Contest, Essay Contest, School Award Medals and American Legion Baseball. Meets as required.

Chairman: DJ Watkins

Vice Chairman (Honor Guard Commander): Rich Jackson

d. Events Committee.

The Events Committee is responsible for planning, organizing and executing Post events. Meets 2nd Monday of the month at 6:00 PM.

Chairman (First Vice Commander): Dennis Clark

Vice Chairman (Son's Rep): Bob McCool

Member (Auxiliary): Dianne Pighetti

Member (Home Association): Mitch DeLong

Members at Large: Dave Spots, Katie Snyder, Rich Seifert

e. Building and Grounds Committee.

The Building and Grounds Committee is responsible for monitoring and maintaining the club's property and facilities, including coordination with external contractors for any necessary construction or maintenance projects. Meets fourth Monday of the month at 6:00 PM.

Chairman: Mitch DeLong

Vice Chairman: Randy Weaver

Member: Dennis Clark

Member: Tom Hammond

Member: DJ Watkins

Member (Scout's Rep): Dave Swisher

f. Finance Committee.

The Finance Committee is responsible for coordinating revenue, receiving donations and executing expenditures among the Post organizations. Meets as required.

Chair (Post Finance Officer): Chris Solo

Auxiliary Representative (Auxiliary Treasurer): Tina Johns

Sons' Representative (Sons' Treasurer): Bob McCool

Riders Representative (Riders Treasurer): Jeff Gonet/Randy Weaver

f. Fundraising Committee.

The Fundraising Committee is responsible for coordinating fundraising activities at the Post; and for planning and executing events which raise funds for the Post.

Chairman: Mitch DeLong

Member: Lynne Corl

Member: Clarke Moyer

Member: DJ Watkins

JULY 2026

SUNDAY	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY	SATURDAY
			1 Pool Room Pool League 6pm-10pm	2 Red Cross Blood Drive 'T Shirt Give A Way' 10am-5pm Thursday Night Cornhole 6pm <i>AL Riders Mtg. 7pm</i>	3 Wing Night 5-9pm	4 Club Closed
5	6 Boy Scouts Meeting 7pm	7	8 Pool Room Pool League 6pm-10pm <i>Legion in the Woods Social Club - Mtg. 6pm Open to all members</i>	9	10 Wing Night 5-9pm	11
12 LEGION CLOSED	13 LEGION CLOSED	14 <i>Special Events Comm. Mtg. 6pm (date change)</i>	15 Pool Room Pool League 6pm-10pm Trivia Wednesday 6pm	16 <i>Post Mtg. 7pm</i>	17 Wing Night 5-9pm	18 Line Dancing by Lion Country 730pm-1030pm
19	20 Boy Scouts Meeting 7pm	21	22 Pool Room Pool League 6pm-10pm	23	24 Wing Night 5-9pm	25
26 Korean War Veteran's Brunch 11am-2pm	27 Boy Scouts Meeting 7pm	28	29 Pool Room Pool League 6pm-10pm	30	31 Wing Night 5-9pm	